PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience securing enterprise environments across higher education and financial technology sectors. I specialise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) operations, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) with CrowdStrike Falcon, and alert triage within a high-tempo security operations function. I have deep experience with email and web security gateways including Mimecast, and have deployed and managed Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), and firewall solutions across large user populations. I bring a proven track record of reducing risk through proactive vulnerability management using tools such as Rapid7, threat hunting aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and building automation-driven incident response workflows. I am ready to contribute immediately to a small, high-performing security team in a financial services environment where technical depth and operational reliability are paramount.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and SOAR:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), SOAR automation and playbook development, detection rule creation and tuning, alert triage and escalation
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight EDR, CrowdStrike Falcon Discover, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Tanium
- **Email and Web Security:** Mimecast email security gateway, web proxy and content filtering, security awareness training programme management
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access policies, MFA deployment and SSO integration, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus, Rapid7, remediation tracking and reporting
- **Firewall and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony, firewall policy management and review, network segmentation
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat hunting and threat intelligence integration
- **Cloud and Endpoint Management:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), PowerShell scripting and automation
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead SIEM and SOAR operations using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel with KQL, managing the full alert triage lifecycle from ingestion through to containment and remediation across an 8,000-user estate.
- Own and evolve the organisation's Endpoint Detection and Response posture using CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent and Insight EDR, including policy configuration, sensor deployment, and weekly threat hunting sessions aligned to MITRE ATT&CK.
- Administer the Mimecast email security gateway, tuning inbound and outbound policies, managing quarantine queues, and running phishing simulation campaigns via the integrated security awareness training module.
- Manage firewall policies on the Check Point Harmony platform, conducting quarterly rule reviews and coordinating firewall change requests in line with change management processes.

- Drive vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation, prioritising findings by exploitability and business impact and tracking remediation to closure with engineering teams.
- Govern identity and access controls across Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, configuring Conditional Access policies, enforcing MFA across all user tiers, and managing BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management for privileged account oversight.
- Develop and maintain SOAR automation playbooks using PowerShell scripting to reduce mean time to respond for common alert categories including phishing, account compromise, and malware containment.
- Lead incident response activities in accordance with NIST 800-61, coordinating cross-functional teams during major security incidents and producing post-incident reports with root cause analysis and lessons learned.
- Collaborate with IT and infrastructure teams to embed security requirements into project delivery, including cloud migrations to Microsoft Azure and endpoint rollouts using Microsoft Intune.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Delivered the organisation's deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across an 8,000-user environment, encompassing policy configuration, onboarding, and operational handover to the security operations team.
- Monitored and triaged security alerts from Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, escalating high-fidelity incidents and documenting findings in line with the incident response playbook.
- Administered Azure AD and Entra ID Identity Protection policies, enforcing risk-based Conditional Access rules and supporting MFA rollout across staff and student populations.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck, producing management-level reports and tracking remediation activities through to verified closure.
- Supported security awareness training initiatives and phishing simulation exercises, producing metrics to measure and improve user susceptibility rates.
- Maintained documentation for security controls against Cyber Essentials Plus, ISO 27001, and NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) requirements, supporting annual certification audits.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Managed end-to-end IT security, quality assurance, and infrastructure operations within a cloud-native SaaS and FinTech environment, supporting a geographically distributed workforce.
- Implemented and maintained identity and access management controls, firewall policies, and endpoint security solutions in line with the company's ISO 27001 information security management programme.
- Conducted regular vulnerability scans and managed patch cadences across Windows and Linux server estates, coordinating with development and DevOps teams to resolve findings within agreed Service Level Agreement (SLA) timescales.
- Deployed and configured Microsoft Intune for Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), managing corporate device enrolment and compliance policies.
- Supported security incident triage and root cause analysis, maintaining a security incident log and producing reports for senior management and compliance stakeholders.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Reduced alert-to-closure time by 40% at UAL through the development of CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM detection rules and automated SOAR playbooks, eliminating manual triage for the five highest-volume alert categories.
- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000 users, achieving full coverage within the agreed project timeline and with zero production outages.
- Improved UAL's Cyber Essentials Plus certification posture by remediating 94% of critical and high vulnerabilities identified during annual assessments, coordinating work across five infrastructure teams.
- Delivered a threat hunting programme at UAL aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, identifying and remediating three previously undetected lateral movement attempts and presenting findings to the CISO and senior leadership team.
- Reduced phishing click rates at UAL by 62% over 18 months through Mimecast-integrated security awareness training campaigns and targeted repeat-offender coaching.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)